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Running Adverse Locally

Step 1 — Create the .env File

Create a file called `.env` in the project root (`adverse/.env`) with the following content:

```
SECRET_KEY=django-insecure-local-dev-key-change-in-production
DEBUG=True
ALLOWED_HOSTS=127.0.0.1,localhost

# Option A: SQLite (easiest for local preview – no PostgreSQL needed)
DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///db.sqlite3

# Option B: PostgreSQL (if you have it running)
# DATABASE_URL=postgres://youruser:yourpassword@localhost:5432/adverse_db

EMAIL_HOST=smtp.gmail.com
EMAIL_PORT=587
EMAIL_HOST_USER=your@email.com
EMAIL_HOST_PASSWORD=yourpassword

RECAPTCHA_SITE_KEY=dummy
RECAPTCHA_SECRET_KEY=dummy

RATELIMIT_ENABLE=False
```

Use **Option A (SQLite)** if you just want to preview locally — no database installation needed.

Step 2 — Activate the Virtual Environment

```
cd "c:\Users\USER\Documents\Davis\Advers\adverse"  
.venv\Scripts\activate
```

Step 3 — Install Dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Step 4 — Run Migrations

```
python manage.py migrate
```

Step 5 — Create a Superuser (for the Admin Panel)

```
python manage.py createsuperuser
```

Enter an email and password when prompted. This account will have `is_staff=True` and can access `/admin-panel/`.

Step 6 — Start the Server

```
python manage.py runserver
```

Then open <http://127.0.0.1:8000> in your browser.

Key URLs to Preview

URL	What you'll see
http://127.0.0.1:8000/adverse-auth/register/	Registration with role selection
http://127.0.0.1:8000/adverse-auth/login/	Login
http://127.0.0.1:8000/admanager/dashboard/	Ad Manager dashboard
http://127.0.0.1:8000/advertiser/dashboard/	Advertiser dashboard
http://127.0.0.1:8000/admin-panel/	Custom admin panel
http://127.0.0.1:8000/admin/	Django built-in admin

Note on Email Verification

Registration requires email verification. Since SMTP won't work with placeholder credentials, manually activate a test user:

1. Go to <http://127.0.0.1:8000/admin/>
2. Log in with your superuser account
3. Navigate to **Security > Custom users**
4. Find your test user and set `is_active = True`
5. Save — the user can now log in